CARGOSHARKS · SALES

Pricing and Packaging

> **Every number on this page is a placeholder.** They are written as `[KWD ####]` so that nothing accidentally ships as a quote. The *structure* is the recommendation; the figures need a costing exercise and one commercial decision per line. §6 lists what has to be decided and by whom.

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1. The shape, and why it is this shape

The product is sold **one deployment per customer** — the customer's own database, their own instance, in the region they choose. That is a data-sovereignty answer as much as an architecture, and in this market it is the strongest thing we sell. It also moves a real, recurring cost onto whoever operates it, and that cost is linear in customers.

So the pricing has to do three things at once:

1. **Recover implementation properly.** Data migration is where these projects die, and an implementation fee that undercharges guarantees a rushed one.
2. **Recover per-deployment operating cost in the recurring line**, because it does not amortise across customers the way multi-tenant hosting does.
3. **Stay decidable in one meeting** for a family business. A structure needing a spreadsheet to understand does not get signed in the Gulf mid-market.

Hence: a small fixed pilot, a fixed implementation, and an annual subscription banded by branches and named users — not by shipment volume.

Not priced per shipment, deliberately. Volume pricing punishes the customer for growing, invites gaming, and turns every renewal into an argument about counting. It also makes the bill unforecastable, which is exactly what a forwarder with thin margins will not accept.

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2. The pilot

Fee	`[KWD ####]` fixed
Duration	15 working days from the day their data lands — not from signature
Credited	In full against the implementation fee if they proceed within `[90]` days
Includes	Their branding, two branches, one rate card, ~20 seeded job files, tracking page, portal, quotation, ops board, hosting for the pilot period
Excludes	Invoicing, agent portal, notifications, production use, real money, real load

Set the fee at the level a managing director signs without convening anyone. Its job is to convert a decision into an experiment, not to be profitable. If the number needs a board, it is wrong.

Say the credit term out loud in the room. It removes the wasted-money objection entirely and makes proceeding the path of least resistance.

The pilot environment stays live for `[60]` days after the demo, because the real selling happens afterwards, internally, when the operations manager shows the owner.

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3. Implementation

Fixed fee, banded by what actually drives the work — which is data, not users.

BAND	SHAPE	FEE
Single branch	One entity, one currency, up to `[300]` customers, up to `[2]` rate cards migrated	`[KWD ####]`
Multi-branch	Up to `[5]` entities, multi-currency, up to `[1,500]` customers, up to `[10]` rate cards	`[KWD ####]`
Group	More than `[5]` entities, or migration of open jobs and open receivables from an existing system	`[quoted]`

What the fee covers: provisioning and hosting setup, branding applied end to end, branch and user configuration, master-data migration (customers, contacts, agents and hauliers, ports and places), rate-card import, milestone templates matched to their vocabulary, document types, working calendars, role and permission configuration, two training sessions per role, and go-live support.

What it does not cover, and why it is separate:

EXCLUDED	WHY	RATE
Cleaning an unusable rate card	It is *their* data quality, and the effort is unbounded until seen	`[KWD ###]` /day
Migrating open jobs and open receivables mid-year	A cutover, not an installation — see below	`[quoted]`
Custom document templates beyond the standard set	Design work	`[KWD ###]` each
Integration with an accounting package	Per package, and unbounded across packages	`[quoted]`
On-site presence outside `[Kuwait]`	Travel	at cost

The cutover surcharge is not a way to charge more. Going live at a period end with a clean master-data load is a different project from going live mid-year carrying open jobs, part-paid invoices and containers already accruing free time. The product supports the second — bulk import handles open jobs and open receivables — but it takes a reconciliation pass that the first does not. Price it separately or absorb it silently forever.

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4. Subscription

Annual, paid annually in advance. Banded by branches and named users.

EDITION	BRANCHES	NAMED USERS	INCLUDES	ANNUAL
Single	1	up to `[10]`	Everything below, one entity	`[KWD ####]`
Network	up to `[5]`	up to `[40]`	Multi-entity, multi-currency, consolidated views	`[KWD ####]`
Group	unlimited	`[quoted]`	Above, plus read API and outbound webhooks	`[quoted]`

Every edition includes the whole product. There is no feature ladder, no "upgrade to unlock the audit log," and no per-module pricing. Three reasons: the capabilities that would be natural upsells — audit, RLS, bilingual, whitelabel — are structural and cannot be switched off without weakening the product; a feature ladder invites a renewal negotiation every year; and a mid-market forwarder reads a matrix of crossed boxes as a warning.

Included in every edition:

- All five modes: sea FCL, sea LCL, air, land, courier
- Enquiry queue with SLA clocks · quotation and award · buy/sell/margin
- Enquiries emailed to a branch mailbox read into a proposal the coordinator accepts or rejects
- Rate cards, buy and sell, with temporal validity and the accessorial catalogue
- Job file, milestones, containers, exceptions, operations board
- Consolidation — master and houses, manifest, cost apportionment across the houses
- Free-time clocks — demurrage, detention, storage — writing their own charge lines
- Customs stage tracking with declaration references, duty estimate, broker and SLA
- Document vault with versioning and per-document release control
- Generated documents — invoice, quotation, house bill of lading or air waybill, delivery order, packing list, customs pack, consolidation manifest — bilingual, numbered per branch, previewed before issue and versioned after
- Public tracking page and branded customer portal, both bilingual
- Job costing, invoicing, receipts, ageing, statements, unbilled-revenue register
- Credit standing against limit and ageing, checked at booking, with recorded overrides
- Payables — supplier bills read from a scan or a known partner's email, matched to the job's cost lines with variances; partner settlements with netting; supplier payments
- Accounting export — a journal of the period, posted once
- Email notifications to customers and staff, templated in both languages
- An assistant over the operator's own data, scoped by the same permissions as the screens
- Two-factor sign-in · vendor-access grants
- Immutable audit trail · configurable reference data · a database that is the operator's own, backed up per tenant
- Bulk import of customers, contacts, partners, locations, rate cards, open jobs, open receivables
- Whitelabel — logo, palette, typography, domain; documents issued under the operator's own entity name
- Arabic and English throughout

Not counted as a named user: customer-portal logins and agent-portal logins. Charging a forwarder for their own customers' access would defeat the feature that makes their customers stop ringing them, which is the thing they are buying.

Portal login limits: none. The point is adoption.

The agent portal is a scaffold in the current release, not a shipped capability — the route exists and is correctly scoped, but RFQ response, rate-card upload and milestone posting by agents are in delivery. Do not list it as included until it ships, and do not let it be discounted for. See `../manual/08-agent-portal.md`.

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5. Hosting and support

Hosting

OPTION	WHAT IT MEANS	ANNUAL
Operated by us	We run the deployment — provisioning, backups, restore drills, monitoring, upgrades, patching	`[KWD ####]`
Customer's own cloud	Their account, their region; we deploy and operate under their subscription	`[KWD ####]`
Customer-operated	They run it; we supply migrations, releases and runbooks	`[KWD ####]` reduced

Region choice is real, and it is worth saying so: **Kuwait, UAE, Saudi or EU.** For a prospect who has been told their data will sit in an unnamed data centre, this is a selling point rather than a line item.

Backups are nightly with `[30]`-day retention. **Restore drills are scheduled, not optional** — `pnpm fleet:restore-drill` restores into a scratch database and verifies the *content*, including that the security policies survived, because a restore that silently drops them produces a database that looks perfect and enforces nothing. Say this to any technical reviewer; it is the single most credible operational claim we have.

Support

TIER	RESPONSE	HOURS	INCLUDED WITH	ANNUAL
Standard	`[1 business day]`	Sun–Thu, `[08:00–17:00 AST]`	every subscription	included
Priority	`[4 business hours]`, `[1 hour]` for a full outage	Sun–Thu extended	—	`[KWD ####]`
Named engineer	`[2 business hours]`, direct line	Sun–Thu extended, on-call for outages	—	`[KWD ####]`

Support is a named person, not a ticket queue. This is a deliberate counter-position to the incumbent complaint — *"if you call CargoWise, they tell you to watch a video"* — and it prices accordingly. Do not undercut it into being unprofitable, or it becomes a promise that quietly stops being kept.

Vendor access is granted by the customer, not held by us. Support cannot see a customer's data by default. Access is granted from *Settings → Vendor access*, scoped to named branches, read-only or read-write, expiring on its own, against a ticket reference — and every session opened under it is recorded in a log neither the customer nor we can edit afterwards. While a grant is live, a banner sits at the top of every page.

Lead with this in any security review. No competitor on the battlecard can say it, and it converts the standard "what can your staff see" question from a liability into a demonstration.

6. What has to be decided before this page is quoted

#	DECISION	OWNER	BLOCKS
1	Per-deployment hosting cost at rest — compute, storage, backups, monitoring, per region	technical	Every hosting figure, and the subscription floor
2	Implementation effort in days for each of the three bands, from the Al-Qabandi engagement's actual hours	delivery	Implementation fees
3	Currency of the price list — KWD, USD or AED — and whether it varies by market	commercial	The whole page
4	Support cost model: how many engineer-hours a deployment consumes per year in steady state	delivery	Support tiers
5	Discount authority: what a salesperson may give without asking	commercial	Every negotiation
6	Multi-year terms — is there a 2- or 3-year price, and what does it lock	commercial	Renewal risk
7	Whether resale is permitted at all under the Al-Qabandi engagement (`Q1`)	legal	**Everything**
8	Who carries the model cost. Email intake, bill reading and the assistant each call a hosted model per use; the cost is small per call (`Dev_Environment.md` records under a cent per bill) but it is metered, and it is either inside the subscription, passed through on the operator's own key, or capped	commercial	The three model-backed lines in §4

7. Discipline at the negotiating table

Discount the term, not the price. A first-year discount that resets is a renewal argument scheduled twelve months out. A two-year commitment at a better annual rate is worth more to both sides and does not teach the customer that the list price is fiction.

Never discount implementation. It is the line where cutting price directly cuts delivered quality, and a rushed migration produces an unhappy reference customer — which in a market this small costs more than the deal was worth.

Give scope, not money, when you must give something. An extra branch, an extra training session, a longer pilot window, an extra document template. Each has a bounded cost and none of them repricies the contract.

Do not sell a deployment to a customer who will not commit to a go-live date. An indefinitely postponed implementation consumes support and delivery attention without ever producing a reference.